

The Life That Is in Christ Is in You

We have been on this Born-Again Trail. It is not that we will not teach other things. When I feel Him lift off me on this, I will put another teacher in or go on to another subject. But we are going to use these services to go where we usually do not go and teach what we normally do not get to teach.

About a year ago, I mentioned that God began to reveal a trail to me. He finally called it the Born-Again Trail. He said that if I followed it out, everything I desired I would be able to receive.

I understand that now as He has been adding line upon line and precept upon precept. When He told me it was on this trail, He took me over and I got a glimpse down the trail. To my amazement, it was the trail of everything I became in Christ Jesus, everything I inherited by faith. If I can inherit it by the power of the Holy Spirit, then I can have it.

All these things He made me were on that trail of faith.

It felt like the gift of faith came on me. I have had the gift of faith come on me several times, usually in the presence of disease. Suddenly the faith of God would come on me. At that moment, thinking like God, it was ridiculous to leave somebody in a wheelchair.

Later you may wake up at night and get into fear, asking, "Why did I do that? Why did I drag them around the building until they walked? Why did I strike that person's arm?"

That is what Jack Coe had. One time they laid a man on the platform in the last stages of death from cancer. He was barely conscious. Jack Coe came up, made a fist, and hit him hard in the stomach while he lay there. The man screamed and rolled off the platform into the sawdust.

My friend who worked with him thought, This is it. We are going to be sued. He killed him.

But the man got up out of the sawdust and started running around the tent, absolutely healed.

Then came the little Jack Coe clones who tried it and ended up hurting people. Doing that does not make the gift of faith come. The gift comes first, and then you do it.

When I saw down this path, I do not quite know whether it was revelation or faith, but the faith of God came on me. The revelation of God came on me. For a time, I knew I could have it. His faith was on me. I knew that if I could walk this path out, I could have it all: as big an inheritance of souls as I wanted, as much power and fellowship with God as I wanted.

I did not know how to do it yet, not completely. But I knew I could. As long as that was on me, I knew.

One more time after that, I had an experience where I was shaking because the revelation of what God had asked me to do came on me.

God had just visited me about Kenneth Hagin's meetings, and how when Jesus visited Kenneth Hagin, He quoted one verse to him four times:

"He that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God... howbeit in the spirit he speaketh mysteries."

Jesus quoted that verse four times to Kenneth Hagin in the last camp meeting during a supernatural visitation when He walked on the platform. A lot of things came together at that time.

We were with Norvel, and Elaine preached and had a transcript of what Kenneth Hagin had received word for word. She read it. When she read it, God came on me, and I felt for the first time the fullness of what He had asked me to do.

I started shaking and could not stop. Nothing like that had ever happened to me that I can remember. Godly fear came on me. I began shaking, wondering, Am I sure I want Him to reveal all this to me? Am I sure? Because when He does, I will become accountable.

I surrendered and wept and could not get over it.

After I said yes, this trail began to open up. Verses I had looked at for years started opening.

The first book I committed to memorization was John. I had just been saved and was working with a crew where the men were cussing. I sat there listening to them, wishing I had a Bible. I did not have a Bible or anything, and I desired one so badly.

We were on break, and a strong impulse came on me. I did not know how God dealt with people yet. I just got up under that impulse and started walking down the track. I probably walked an eighth of a mile. I was still in view of the work crew, the signalmen for the railroad.

There on the track was a small booklet of the Gospel of John, just lying there. I picked it up, came back, started reading it, and could not put it down. That night I went home and started memorizing it until I got a Bible.

I could close my eyes and meditate:

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.
The same was in the beginning with God.
All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made.
In him was life; and the life was the light of men.
And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not.
There was a man sent from God, whose name was John..."

God knows how many years those verses have been with me, and I had never heard anybody really preach on them. I had heard people go verse by verse through a Gospel or epistle and make little off-the-wall comments on each verse as they traveled to the "good stuff."

I found out that one reason I did not understand everything I needed to know was that the verses we thought did not mean anything were generally the ones that meant everything. The reason we did not understand them was that we were not yet in a place where we could understand them.

I asked God, "Where are these great verses: 'All things are possible to him that believeth,' 'Nothing shall be impossible unto you,' 'The works that I do shall ye do also, and greater works than these,' and 'It is expedient for you that I go away'?"

Gary got into this and said, "No, it would be better if You were here."

If you had a mother-in-law or grandmother with multiple sclerosis or Alzheimer's, and Jesus was in Jerusalem, you could put her on a plane. You might have to wait a few months to get to Him, but if you put her in the crowd He was praying for, you know she would come back healed.

So if it was expedient that He go away, what made it better for Him to go? It was because the works He did would be multiplied. One believer can walk in that power to cast devils out and lay hands on the sick. In fact, it is a powerful tool of evangelism. You could go door to door and say, "Do you have any sick in this house?"

But the problem is, we have holed up in accountability and just tried to get each other healed. We say, "Do you need healing? Yes. How about you? Yes." But Jesus said these signs will follow those who believe. If the signs follow the believer, then who is the person getting healed?

It was expedient for Jesus to go away because by man came the fall, and by Man came redemption. He sat down at the right hand of the Father. It was expedient that He go away to finish the redemption work.

He said, "The works I do, you shall do also; and greater works than these."

The thing is, we have not caught on to who we are. We have not caught on to our inheritance, and we have not caught on to how that inheritance comes.

For years, I ministered with many of the best. The only reason I did was because of the anointing I carried under what I had. I did the Mile High Conferences at Wally and Marilyn Hickey's for eleven years because I could teach and miracles happened. They liked me because of the anointing, and the teachers liked me because I could teach.

Yet all those years, with what was resting on me, I still did not know what He had waiting for me.

I have compassion on the multitudes sitting in churches, put on certain limbs, while we never get around to our inheritance. We have fragments and live in parts. We do not really understand who we have been made.

Thank God for faith people. They have come closest with "We are the righteousness of God in Christ." Jesus was made sin for me, and I have been made the righteousness of God in Christ. We know we have been put in right standing with Him. That begins the trail.

John 1 begins:

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.
The same was in the beginning with God.
All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made."

That speaks of Jesus' position in eternity past as the mighty Word before anything had a beginning.

But in verse 4, John changes to His humanity:

"In him was life; and the life was the light of men."

The life that was in Him was that He was the first Man born spiritually alive since Adam. That life was a human spirit born spiritually alive.

Then He died, and we identified with Him in that death. He was raised from the dead. That same life that was in Him has now become the life that is in you. When you were born again, God quickened your spirit and brought it from death to life.

You do not have Jesus' spirit. You have your own human spirit. But you have the Spirit of Christ, because the same thing that happened in Him when God quickened Him and raised Him from the dead happened in you.

When I bowed my knee to Him and was born again, He quickened my spirit and brought it from death to life. I have the Spirit that is in Christ because God brought Him from death to life. I have that same life in me. It is not His human spirit. It is my human spirit that was quickened, but it is the Spirit of Christ.

I had the spirit of Adam. I did not have Adam's spirit; I had my own. But I had the spirit of Adam because I inherited his death. Now I have the Spirit of Christ because I have inherited His life.

I have been born again.

When I was born again, I became His son, and with my rebirth I received an incredible inheritance. Then He sent the Holy Spirit, and the Holy Spirit is the earnest of my inheritance. Heaven put a down payment on me and gave me the Holy Ghost. He is the power to see to it that if I give myself over to Him, He will bring me into the fullness of my inheritance.

The Holy Spirit brought a supernatural prayer language with Him. It is almost like an "idiot switch." Suppose you do not know what the Word says, you are sitting under a gospel that will not take you anywhere, and besides that, you are very slow. I am speaking hypothetically.

Suddenly you are baptized in the earnest. He brings a language with Him and says:

"I know you. I know your condition. I know everything. I would like you to move across the country and sit under Roberson so he will badger you into prayer. If he can badger you into prayer, then you will release Me to work that inheritance in you. I do not care how slow you are. I do not care if you are missing fingers, nose, or eyes. If you will stay with Me, I will bring you to full inheritance, and you will get all those things back."

Hallelujah.

Your inheritance is not just spiritual. It covers you now. I am not going to preach some sympathy gospel that says I cannot walk, so people will carry me into the jungle and I will lie there preaching to people. They may carry me into the jungle, and I may lie there for a while. But when I come into my inheritance, I am going to get up.

He does not want me running around the world preaching like that and using it as proof of how humble I am. Be humble enough to become teachable. Find out how to walk out of it and how to keep working that inheritance.

Some of you have found out you cannot earn it, so you might as well learn how to yield yourself to the Spirit so He can show you how to release it. Every one of you is sitting on that potential.

Hallelujah.

Go to John 5. Begin around verse 7:

"The impotent man answered him, Sir, I have no man, when the water is troubled, to put me into the pool:
but while I am coming, another steppeth down before me.
Jesus saith unto him, Rise, take up thy bed, and walk.
And immediately the man was made whole, and took up his bed, and walked: and on the same day was the sabbath."

I like those words, "Rise, take up your bed, and walk." I plan on saying them a lot.

The same day was the Sabbath. Is it not something that it was the Sabbath that set us free? They could not see healing on the Sabbath.

The Jews said to the man who was cured, "It is the Sabbath day. It is not lawful for you to carry your bed."

I can see him thinking, If you had been on this thing as long as I have, kill me if you want. I am not laying back down on it.

He answered, "He that made me whole, the same said unto me, Take up thy bed, and walk."

Included in the Sabbath, which is your born-again experience where you enter into rest and cease from your own sins, not by works lest any man should boast, is the gift of God. Included in that rest is healing.

Of course, I am going ahead into our covenant. The man simply answered:

"He that made me whole, the same said unto me, Take up thy bed, and walk."

They asked, "What man is that which said unto thee, Take up thy bed, and walk?"

He did not know who it was, for Jesus had conveyed Himself away, a multitude being in that place. Afterward Jesus found him in the temple and said:

"Behold, thou art made whole: sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee."

The man departed and told the Jews it was Jesus who had made him whole. Therefore the Jews persecuted Jesus and sought to slay Him because He had done these things on the Sabbath.

Then Jesus made them even more angry:

"My Father worketh hitherto, and I work."

In other words, "My Father did this miracle on the Sabbath, so I will work on the Sabbath too. If the power came from God to raise this man, and He is doing it, then it must be all right to do it on the Sabbath."

The Jews were infuriated. They sought all the more to kill Him because He not only had broken the Sabbath, but said God was His Father, making Himself equal with God.

John 5:19-20 says:

"Then answered Jesus and said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you,
The Son can do nothing of himself, but what he seeth the Father do:
for what things soever he doeth, these also doeth the Son likewise.
For the Father loveth the Son, and sheweth him all things that himself doeth:
and he will show him greater works than these, that ye may marvel."

The "greater works than these" He was talking about were greater than the healing of the impotent man that the Jews marveled over. There is only one thing greater than taking an impotent man who had not walked in thirty-eight years and making him whole, or even raising someone naturally from the dead.

In the Old Testament, God could take a man's spirit out of Abraham's bosom, put it back into his body, and let him run around on the earth again. That is a great miracle. Healing a man born blind is a great miracle. But there was one greater work left.

That greater work was when the Father would give the Son His life back.

Romans says Abraham stood before Him who quickens the dead and calls those things which be not as though they were. What God was actually calling as though it was, though it was not yet, was that He would raise Jesus from the dead and quicken Him.

God was saying, "Abraham, do you believe I can quicken the dead? Do you believe I can take a dead spirit and bring it from death to life?"

Abraham said yes.

God said, "Good. I am calling those things that be not, which is your dead spirit, as though it was alive. I am going to impute righteousness to you. Even though you are as dead as a doornail, you will have the benefit of righteousness. Charge it to the cross. In that day, every promissory note you cash in on, I will pay in full when I quicken Jesus from the dead and give you righteousness."

That is the promise Jesus was getting ready to fulfill.

John 5:21 says:

"For as the Father raiseth up the dead, and quickeneth them; even so the Son quickeneth whom he will."

In the King James, the word "them" is italicized because the translators added it to try to clarify the verse. I wish they had left it alone. What it says is:

"Even as the Father raises up the dead and makes alive, thus also the Son, whom He will, makes alive."

There is no plural there. Jesus had just said the Father would show Him, the Son, greater works than these. Who else could the Father quicken first? Who else was qualified? He could have quickened all the Old Testament saints, but the price had not been paid. The first Man qualified was Jesus.

The Father raised up the dead and made alive by doing that greater work in Christ. Then Christ turned around and said, "Now the life in Me is the light of men. I quicken whom I will."

John 5:21-24 continues:

"For as the Father raiseth up the dead, and quickeneth them; even so the Son quickeneth whom he will.

For the Father judgeth no man, but hath committed all judgment unto the Son:

That all men should honour the Son, even as they honour the Father.

He that honoureth not the Son honoureth not the Father which hath sent him.

Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life."

The Father committed all judgment to the Son because in Jesus all men have been judged. If One died for all, then all were dead. The penalty of the sins of the whole world was laid upon one Man.

Jesus died under the penalty of our sin while we were still lost in trespasses and sins, with no guarantee we would ever accept Him. That is why all judgment is in the Son's hands. The judgment of God was poured out upon Him. Whether you accepted Him or not, He still stood in your place.

All judgment for every human being, including Stalin, Lenin, and Hitler, was laid on Him. All judgment was committed into His hands because all judgment was carried out in Him.

So if you accept Him and He says you are whole, you are whole, because you received His life.

John 5:26 says:

"For as the Father hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself."

The life that was in God was in Christ, and now it is in you. I have been born again. I am no longer a servant. I have become a son, and nobody will ever talk me out of that again.

As the Father has life in Himself, He gave the Son to have life in Himself. Jesus' human spirit is His own spirit. That life was the first man's spirit to be born spiritually alive. Later, after judgment, after His spirit became our sin sacrifice, He was born again like you were. He was raised from the dead.

He still has His life in Himself. You have your life in yourself like God has life in Himself, because you are a human being, Jesus in His glorified humanity is a human being, and God is God. You are an individual, and Jesus is an individual, but you received the Spirit of Christ.

He was the Firstborn of many brethren. The same life that came into existence in Him has come into existence in you. That life was in the Father. He gave it to the Son. It was in Him. Now it is in you.

I have been born again.

It was hard for me to understand this, especially when I ministered in maximum-security prisons. A man who had machine-gunned a pregnant woman hugged me as a brother, picked me up, and my feet dangled while he hugged me.

When I understand what it cost heaven to redeem me, I can tell you this much: I am free. I am not going to take away from the Holy Spirit by justifying failure.

When we get to Romans 6, we will see that the body of sin was destroyed, and he that is dead is freed from sin. Sin does not have dominion over you. That is what the Holy Spirit uses to work with.

I can take it away from Him very easily by justifying sin and failure. He has nothing to work with except what you received in your inheritance.

That is why people die. They die because they take away from the Holy Spirit all He has to work with. What you received in your inheritance when you were born again is what He has to work with.

Go ahead and say the devil made you do it. Go ahead and excuse yourself. Blame your wife, husband, or dog for your failures and your ministry. But you are the one who has that life in yourself. The Holy Spirit is the One to bring forth your life. You cannot bring forth another person's life for you.

When you quit justifying failure, at last you put into the Holy Ghost's hands what He needs: what He made you when you were born again.

When you let Him bring that forward, my God.

When I found out how free I am, do you think I am going to justify not winning the world? No. I may not be there yet. I may not yet be at that place in my inheritance. But I know the only Person who can bring me there is the Holy Ghost, because this is not my works.

I know I am going to get there because I am fellowshiping with the Holy Ghost. There is one thing for sure: I am going to keep giving the Holy Ghost what He needs from me to get me there.

You do not do that by excusing yourself, justifying your failures, or claiming sin has dominion over you because you cannot put something down or stop doing something.

You may not understand it in your intellect or flesh, but until you stop justifying something that does not have more power than what He has made you, you will never get free.

You are better off standing up and saying, "I may not understand it, but one thing I do know is that I am free. I know the Holy Ghost is working my freedom, and one day I am going to get to that junction in the road where whatever is hanging on me will have to turn loose."

Sin does not have dominion over you, and neither do its friends. Poverty, disease, and depression do not have their root in righteousness. They have their root in spiritual death. Once the generator is destroyed, once the foundation, the body of sin, has been destroyed, those things have nothing to keep them alive unless you keep them alive.

I am not going to keep them alive.

Now that I am beginning to understand how He took me from servant to son, and what He has done in me, I am not going to waste what He made me.

Now I understand why men like Stalin, Hitler, and Lenin could have a deathbed experience and be saved. That used to be hard for me. I thought too much in the natural.

In Latvia, Rick took us out to the graves where they dug holes with bulldozers and erected a monument because they buried fifty thousand in each hole. They took us to the concentration camp. I walked through it. When people got too weak to work from starvation and cold, they marched them over to the pit.

That is what those men thought of human life.

You think, A man like that should be punished. Stalin should be punished. Lenin should be punished. Hitler should be punished. They sent millions of people to hell.

That is what was hard for me to understand. If I were a mass murderer, I would be responsible for sending people to hell, because everybody you kill is not going to be born again.

Suppose a mass murderer who sent millions to hell is on his deathbed. Some little grandmother breaks through, takes him by the hand, and he is panicking and sorry anyway, looking for help.

He says, "Can you help me?"

She says, "Yes, I can help you."

He has a strong deathbed conversion and is born again.

Later I walk into heaven and see him there. I say, "Wait a minute. This man was a mass murderer. You let him in here?"

They check the records and say, "No, he is not a mass murderer. This man came into existence only a short time ago. He does not have that record. We checked thoroughly. We also checked earth's records at your request. There was a man by that name who lived in the time you said, but he was punished in hell for his crimes. All the punishment he had coming was laid upon Jesus. This man accepted Jesus Christ as his Savior, therefore his punishment was shifted onto Jesus, and Jesus bore it."

Either you believe Jesus was made sin for you, or you do not. If you believe it, then you have to believe He bore the sins of the world. All judgment was laid upon Him. There is no sin any sinner can commit from now until the end of the millennium that He did not bear.

It does not matter how much of a mass murderer a man was. Maybe he did send people to hell. When Jesus took that man's punishment and the man became a new creation, he went from servant to son. He is now a son of God with the same inheritance you have, because old things have passed away and all things have become new.

If you do not take advantage of what He made you when He made you a son of God, you are a foolish man or woman. You have been freed, and your earnest is the Holy Spirit. Until you let Him bring forward what He has made you, you will flounder around in works.

I suggest prayer, worship, and meditation on your inheritance. The New Testament is the will left in blood for your inheritance, because a testament is always drawn up after the death of the testator.

Jesus died. He has risen from the dead. This is the new will.

Meditate on it until it becomes part of you and you become part of it, because that is where your life is.

Hallelujah, Jesus.